



THE BOOK

THE UNTOLD STORY OF COMPUTERS

Written by John Crestani

Free PDF · 87 pages · 50+ citations

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FUN FACT

John has sold over 20,000 copies of his books via TV infomercial and built a 7-figure business for over a decade with zero employees.

MISSION & OVERVIEW

Mission: I show business owners why owning their AI stack is the biggest leverage play of this decade — and give them the tools to do it.

I started my first online business in 2012 after two years at a marketing agency. That business did seven figures every year since 2014, all without employees. I sold over 20,000 copies of my books through TV infomercials and built one of the largest affiliate marketing education platforms online. In 2024 I pivoted to AI infrastructure. My company, M3M3TIC LLC, builds Bonfire Terminal — a local-first AI platform that lets business owners own their AI tools with a one-time perpetual license instead of paying \$1,000+ per month in SaaS subscriptions. My new book, *The Untold Story of Computers*, lays out the data: the \$638 billion AI market, what 2,400 CEOs told BCG, and why ownership beats rental.

SUGGESTED INTRODUCTION

Today I am joined by John Crestani, author of The Untold Story of Computers and founder of Bonfire Terminal. John spent a decade building seven-figure online businesses before pivoting to AI infrastructure. His new book lays out why the \$638 billion AI market is creating the biggest income opportunity of our generation — and why most businesses are on the wrong side of it. His company, Bonfire Terminal, lets business owners own their AI tools instead of renting them through monthly subscriptions. He lives in Malibu with his wife and daughter.

TOPICS TO TALK ABOUT

- Why the average business spends \$230,000 on SaaS over 10 years and owns nothing
- The \$638 billion AI market and what 2,400 CEOs are doing right now
- How AI is replacing entire departments (Klarna cut 853 jobs with one AI assistant)
- Why owning your AI infrastructure beats renting it from Big Tech
- The Transformer paper that started the AI revolution (and why business owners should care)
- Building a company with zero employees using AI-powered systems

QUESTIONS YOU CAN ASK

- Your book says businesses spend \$230,000 on software they will never own. What is the alternative?
- You compare SaaS subscriptions to the fiat monetary system. Can you explain that analogy?
- What is Bonfire Terminal and how does it let someone own their AI instead of renting it?
- The book has a chapter called Breach, Spy, Train, Repeat. What is the biggest risk of keeping your business on cloud platforms?
- You went from affiliate marketing to building an AI company. What triggered that shift?
- You sold 20,000 books through TV infomercials. How does that experience inform how you market AI tools?
- If someone is spending \$1,000 a month on software subscriptions right now, what should they do first?